

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 7 3
♥ 9 5 4
♦ A 7 3
♣ 10 9 2

♠ J 9 6 5

♥ 8 7 3

♦ 8 4

♣ A 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 2

♥ A 10 2

♦ K Q J 10 6 5

♣ 5 3

♠ A 8 4

♥ K Q J 6

♦ 9 2

♣ K Q J 7

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♦

Dbl

Pass

3 ♣

2 ♦

Dbl

All Pass

3 ♣ by North

Lead: ♦ K

The bidding has been as shown.

Now that West has stolen your response you aren't strong enough to make a free-bid at the 2-level. You pass, East bids 2 ♦ and partner doubles again. Now what?

This is not a penalty double, partner is merely repeating his request for you to name a suit. But now he expects you to choose between ♥s and ♣s.

You bid 3 ♣ and everybody passes.

You may be one too high, but that still might be a good score if they can make 2 ♦.

Board 2

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
 ♥ 8 7
 ♦ A K Q J 6 3
 ♣ J 9 6 3

♠ A 9 7 5

♥ K J 3

♦ 9 7

♣ K Q 5 2



♠ K Q J 10 4 2

♥ A 4 2

♦ 10 5

♣ 10 7

♠ 8 3

♥ Q 10 9 6 5

♦ 8 4 2

♣ A 8 4

West

1 ♦

All Pass

2 ♥ by South

Lead: ♦ K

North

Dbl

East

1 ♠

South

2 ♥

The bidding has been as shown.

After East bids you are no longer forced to respond to partner's Takeout Double. You may pass if you want to.

But if you don't pass you are making what is called a "free bid". You should have 6 or more points and a reason for wanting to bid - like your 5-card ♥ suit.

You bid 2 ♥ and everybody passes.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 4
♥ Q 9 7 5 2
♦ 9 5 2
♣ 7 6 3

♠ A Q 10 2
♥ 6 3
♦ K Q J 8 4
♣ K 9



♠ K 8 7 3
♥ K J 4
♦ 7 6
♣ A Q 5 2

♠ J 9 6
♥ A 10 8
♦ A 10 3
♣ J 10 8 4

West	North	East	South
1♥	1♦	Dbl	Rdbl
All Pass	Pass	Pass	2♦
2♦ by North			
Lead: ♦6			

The bidding has been as shown.

The redouble has taken the force from you - you can pass if you want to. But if you pass, the most likely scenario is that North will also pass. So partner will either have to let them play 1♦ redoubled (which will be a disaster for your side) or take out his own double by bidding some suit. So he will bid a suit and it will almost surely be 1♠.

You can help your side the most by bidding 1♥ immediately. You don't have to worry that partner will believe you have a good hand; both he and North have 13+ points and South's redouble shows 10 or more. He knows there are no points remaining for you to have.

On this deal your ♥ bid gets passed around to South who bids 2♦, the final contract.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 5 4
 ♥ A J 10 6 5 3
 ♦ 8 5 4
 ♣ 7

♠ K 10 9 7

♥ 8

♦ A K 7 3

♣ A J 9 6



♠ Q J 8 6 2

♥ 9 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 5 3 2

♠ 3

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 10 6 2

♣ K Q 10 8 4

West	North	East	South
2♥	Dbl	Pass	3♥
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♣
Pass	5♣		
All Pass			
5♣ by South			
Lead: ♦4			

The bidding has been as shown.

The problem with making a Takeout Double of a preemptive bid is that the bidding for your side starts out a level or two higher. So you can't risk doubling with a flimsy hand. However, this hand is certainly good enough so you double. Partner responds 3♥.

After partner cuebids the next job is to find a suit, so you bid 3♠. Partner now bids 4♣.

You cannot stop short of game. Partner has apparently rejected your ♠ suggestion. Since you are happy to play in ♣s you bid 5♣.